

STATS AND FACTS

The lifestyle of *Brontoscorpio* is very poorly understood. Some scientists think that it may have been semi- or fully aquatic based on studies that assume that the oldest scorpions were aquatic. However, others are still unsure about its habitat, and exactly when these creatures began living on land is still not known for certain.

SIZE



in
cm

20
50
100

Based on fossil remains, scientists have estimated that *Brontoscorpio* could have grown to at least 35½ in (90 cm) in length.

At 9 in (23 cm) long, the giant forest scorpion is the largest modern-day scorpion.

Brontoscorpio may have had a large, deadly stinger on the end of its tail.

This scorpion may have used its pedipalps to bring food to its jaws.

Brontoscorpio's pedipalps may have been clawlike, much like those of modern scorpions.

GIANT STINGER

BRONTOSCORPIO

Despite being the largest scorpion to have ever lived, not much is known about *Brontoscorpio*, also referred to as “thunder scorpion.” Only one fossil of this creature has been discovered, possibly because it had no hard tissue such as teeth or bones anywhere on its body. This fossil consists of a portion of one of *Brontoscorpio*'s smaller “arms,” called a pedipalp. However, its discovery has allowed paleontologists to estimate the size of this giant scorpion—it may have been almost five times the size of the largest scorpion alive today.